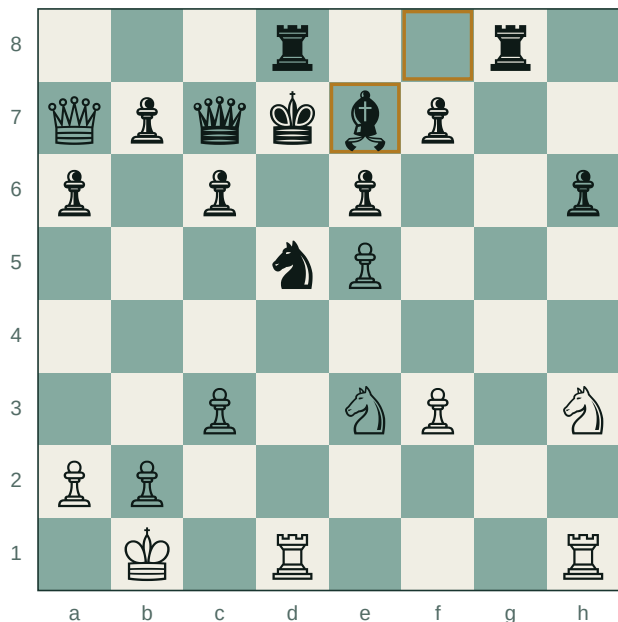


Pins and pressure: White, move 26

Pins and pressure

White to move



Previous move: 25...Be7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26. c4 b6 27. Qxc7+ Kxc7 28. cxd5

26.c4 The pawn moves from c3 to c4. Recorded reply: **26...b6**.

27.Qxc7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From c7 it attacks king on d7 and rook on d8. Recorded reply: **27...Kxc7**.

28.cxd5 The pawn captures the knight on d5.

At the end, nominal material is White 21 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on d7. Absolute pin: knight on d5.